

Ascension Lutheran Church

6481 Old Canton Road Jackson · Mississippi · 39211

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www.ascensionlutheran.com

10:00 AM — July 19, 2026

The Lectionary 16

Leader Guide

Welcome to Ascension. We are glad that you have chosen to worship with us today! May the Holy Spirit bless us as we worship and praise God together.

*“ * ” Indicates when the congregation stands.*

Bold lettering indicates the congregation reads aloud in UNISON.

GATHERING CHIMES: Worship Begins

PRELUDE

All Glory Be to God on High — Johann Pachelbel

WELCOME

*CONFESSION AND FORGIVENESS

All may make the sign of the cross, the sign that is marked at baptism, as the presiding minister begins.

P: Blessed be the holy Trinity,† one God, whose compassion endures forever.

Amen.

P: Let us confess our sin to God.

Silence is kept for reflection.

P: Compassionate God,
we confess to you all our sins.
Our burden is heavy, and we
cannot free ourselves. In your
mercy, call us back to you. Your

yoke is easy and your burden is
light. Restore us to dwell in your
peace. In Christ's name we pray,
Amen.

P: Jesus says, “Come to me, all
you who are weary and are
carrying heavy burdens, and I will
give you rest.” In the name of God,
Father, † Son, and Holy Spirit,
your sins are forgiven. Rest in
God's love.

Amen.

***GATHERING HYMN: ELW 736**

1 God the sculptor of the mountains,
God the miller of the sand,
God the jeweler of the heavens,
God the potter of the land:
you are womb of all creation,
we are formless; shape us now.

2 God the nuisance to the Pharaoh,
God the cleaver of the sea,
God the pillar in the darkness,
God the beacon of the free:
you are fount of all deliv'rance,
we are sightless; lead us now.

3 God the dresser of the vineyard,
God the planter of the wheat,
God the reaper of the harvest,
God the source of all we eat:
you are host at ev'ry table,
we are hungry; feed us now.

4 God the unexpected infant,
God the calm, determined youth,
God the table-turning prophet,
God the resurrected truth:
you are present ev'ry moment,
we are searching; meet us now.

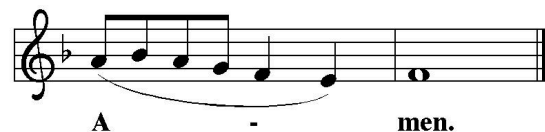
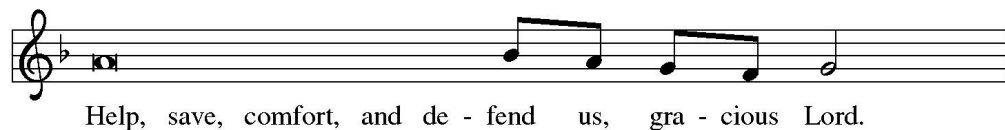
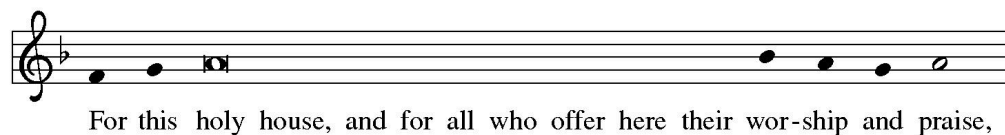
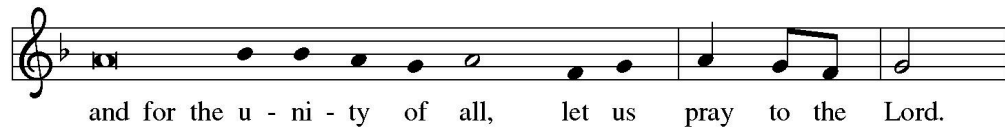
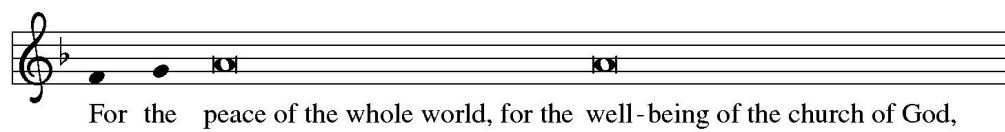
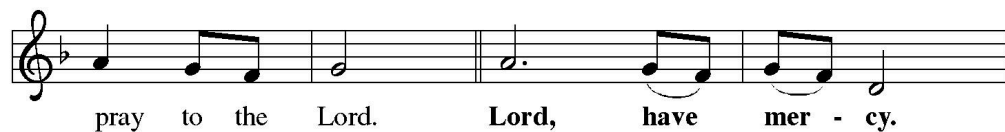
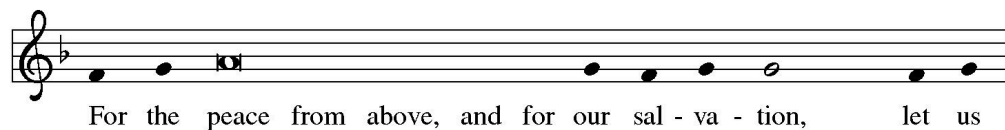
Text: John Thornburg, b. 1954

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P: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Spirit be with you all.

And also with you.

*KYRIE



*CANTICLE OF PRAISE

Refrain



Glo-ry to God in the high-est, and peace to God's peo-ple on earth.



1 Lord God, heav-en-ly King, al-might-y God and Fa-ther, we



wor-ship you, we give you thanks, we praise you for your glo-ry.

Refrain



Glo-ry to God in the high-est, and peace to God's peo-ple on earth.



2 Lord Je-sus Christ, on-ly Son of the Fa-ther, Lord God, Lamb of



God, you take a-way the sin of the world: have mer-cy on us; you are



seat-ed at the right hand of the Fa-ther: re-ceive our prayer.

Refrain



Glo-ry to God in the high-est, and peace to God's peo-ple on earth.



3 For you a-lone are the Ho-ly One, you a-lone are the Lord,



you a-lone are the Most High, Je-sus Christ, with the Ho-ly



Spir-it, in the glo-ry of God the Fa-ther. A-men.

Refrain



Glo-ry to God in the high-est, and peace to God's peo-ple on earth.

Faithful God, most merciful judge, you care for your children with firmness and compassion. By your Spirit nurture us who live in your kingdom, that we may be rooted in the way of your Son, Jesus Christ, our Savior and Lord.

Amen.

First Reading: Isaiah 44:6-8

Scripture Reader

There are no other gods besides God: the word of the Lord does not fail to come to pass. We can trust in God, through whom Israel—and we—are redeemed.

⁶ Thus says the LORD, the King of Israel,
and his Redeemer, the LORD of hosts:

I am the first, and I am the last;
besides me there is no god.

⁷ Who is like me? Let them proclaim it;
let them declare and set it forth before me.
Who has announced from of old the things to come?
Let them tell us what is yet to be.

⁸ Do not fear or be afraid;
have I not told you from of old and declared it?
You are my witnesses!
Is there any god besides me?
There is no other rock; I know not one.

The word of the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

Psalm 86:11-17

The Congregation reads responsively

Teach me your way, O Lord, and I will walk in your truth. (Ps. 86:11)

¹¹ Teach me your way, O Lord, and I will walk in your truth;
give me an undivided heart to revere your name.

**¹² I will thank you, O Lord my God, with all my heart,
and glorify your name forevermore.**

¹³ For great is your love toward me;
you have delivered me from the pit of death.

**¹⁴ The arrogant rise up against me, O God, and a band of violent
people seeks my life;
they have not set you before their eyes.**

¹⁵ But you, O Lord, are gracious and full of compassion,
slow to anger, and full of kindness and truth.

**¹⁶ Turn to me and have mercy on me;
give your strength to your servant, and save the child of your
handmaid.**

¹⁷ Show me a sign of your favor, so that those who hate me may see it and
be put to shame;
because you, Lord, have helped me and comforted me.

Second Reading: Romans 8:12-25

Scripture Reader

For Paul, true spirituality means that we experience the reality of the Spirit, which enables us to pray as God's children, keeps us in solidarity with creation, and gives us unseen hope that God will liberate us and creation from bondage to death and decay.

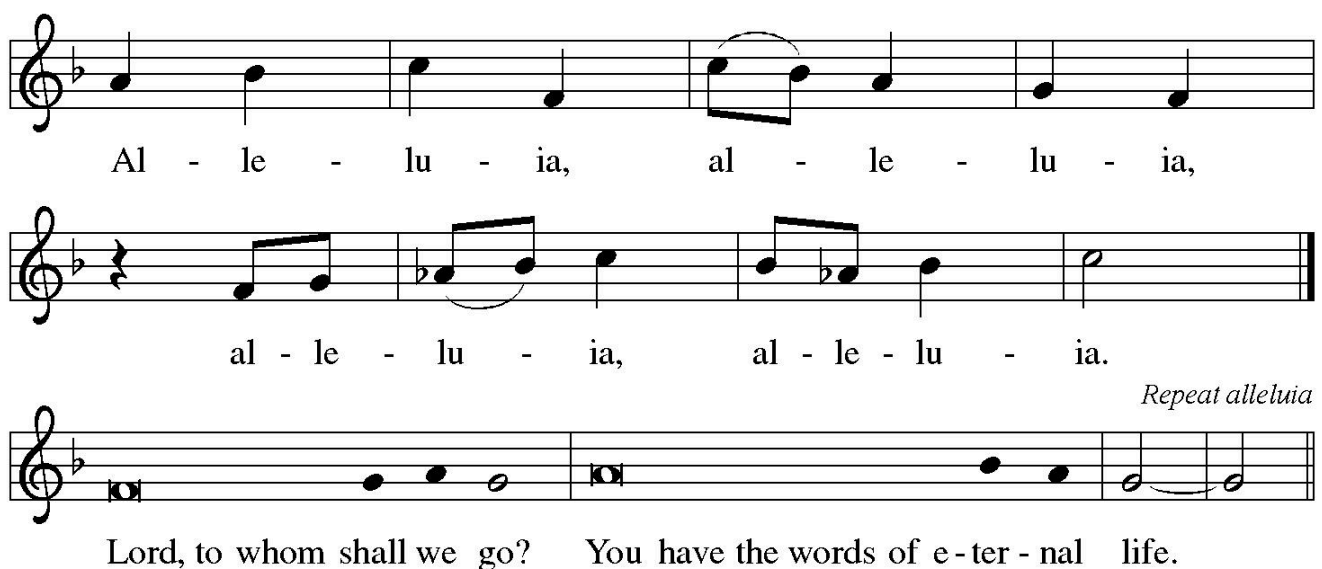
¹² So then, brothers and sisters, we are obligated, not to the flesh, to live according to the flesh—¹³ for if you live according to the flesh, you will die, but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live. ¹⁴ For all who are led by the Spirit of God are children of God. ¹⁵ For you did not receive a spirit of slavery to fall back into fear, but you received a spirit of adoption. When we cry, “Abba! Father!” ¹⁶ it is that very Spirit bearing witness with our spirit that we are children of God, ¹⁷ and if children, then heirs: heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ, if we in fact suffer with him so that we may also be glorified with him.

¹⁸ I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worth comparing with the glory about to be revealed to us. ¹⁹ For the creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the children of God, ²⁰ for the creation was subjected to futility, not of its own will, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope ²¹ that the creation itself will be set free from its enslavement to decay and will obtain the freedom of the glory of the children of God. ²² We know that the whole creation has been groaning together as it suffers together the pains of labor, ²³ and not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly while we wait for adoption, the redemption of our bodies. ²⁴ For in hope we were saved. Now hope that is seen is not hope, for who hopes for what one already sees? ²⁵ But if we hope for what we do not see, we wait for it with patience.

The word of the Lord.
Thanks be to God.

***GOSPEL ACCLAMATION (SUNG)**

Congregation



Al - le - lu - ia, al - le - lu - ia,

al - le - lu - ia, al - le - lu - ia.

Repeat alleluia

Lord, to whom shall we go? You have the words of e - ter - nal life.

* Gospel: Matthew 13:24-30, 36-43

Jesus tells a parable about the coexistence of good and evil in this world. God's judgment will remove all evildoers and causes of sin, but not until the end of human history.

Pastor: The holy gospel according to St. Matthew.

Glory to You, O Lord.

²⁴ [Jesus] put before [the crowds] another parable: "The kingdom of heaven may be compared to someone who sowed good seed in his field,²⁵ but while everybody was asleep an enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat and then went away. ²⁶ So when the plants came up and bore grain, then the weeds appeared as well. ²⁷ And the slaves of the householder came and said to him, 'Master, did you not sow good seed in your field? Where, then, did these weeds come from?' ²⁸ He answered, 'An enemy has done this.' The slaves said to him, 'Then do you want us to go and gather them?' ²⁹ But he replied, 'No, for in gathering the weeds you would uproot the wheat along with them. ³⁰ Let both of them grow together until the harvest, and at harvest time I will tell the reapers, Collect the weeds first and bind them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn.' "

³⁶ Then he left the crowds and went into the house. And his disciples approached him, saying, "Explain to us the parable of the weeds of the field." ³⁷ He answered, "The one who sows the good seed is the Son of Man; ³⁸ the field is the world, and the good seed are the children of the kingdom; the weeds are the children of the evil one, ³⁹ and the enemy who sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the age, and the reapers are angels. ⁴⁰ Just as the weeds are collected and burned up with fire, so will it be at the end of the age. ⁴¹ The Son of Man will send his angels, and

they will collect out of his kingdom all causes of sin and all evildoers, ⁴² and they will throw them into the furnace of fire, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. ⁴³ Then the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Let anyone with ears listen!"
This is the gospel of our Lord. Praise to you, O Christ.

The congregation is seated.

SERMON

*SERMON HYMN: ELW 733

1 Great is thy faithfulness, O
God my Father;
there is no shadow of turning
with thee;
thou changest not, thy
compassions they fail not;
as thou hast been, thou
forever wilt be.

Refrain

Great is thy faithfulness! Great
is thy faithfulness!
Morning by morning new
mercies I see;
all I have needed thy hand hath
provided;
great is thy faithfulness, Lord,
unto me!

2 Summer and winter and
springtime and harvest,
sun, moon, and stars in their
courses above
join with all nature in manifold
witness
to thy great faithfulness,
mercy, and love. Refrain

3 Pardon for sin and a peace
that endureth,
thine own dear presence to
cheer and to guide;
strength for today and bright
hope for tomorrow,
blessings all mine, with ten
thousand beside! Refrain

Text: Thomas O. Chisholm, 1866-1960

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***APOSTLES CREED**

Prayer Leader

I believe in God, the Father
almighty,
creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, God's
only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy
Spirit,
born of the virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was
buried;
he descended to the dead.
On the third day he rose again;

he ascended into heaven,
he is seated at the right hand of
the Father,
and he will come to judge the
living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting.
Amen.

***PRAYERS OF INTERCESSION**

Prayer Leader

As each petition of the prayers ends:

Leader: God of grace,

CONGREGATION: hear our prayer.

***SHARING OF THE PEACE**

Pastor

P: The peace of Christ be with you always.

C: And also with you.

We greet one another with a sign of Christ's peace, saying "Peace be with you," as we shake hands or share a hug.

OFFERING

P: We know that all that we are and all that we have come from God.
So, in response to God's goodness, we give with cheerful hearts.

OFFERTORY

Seek Ye First — Karen Lafferty

Come, Lord Jesus

The musical score is written on three staves in G major (one sharp). The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). It contains two parts: Part 1, marked with a '1' and an asterisk, and Part 2, marked with a '2'. The melody consists of quarter and eighth notes. The lyrics are written below the staves, with the first two lines corresponding to the first staff and the remaining lines to the second and third staves. The lyrics are: '1 Oh, come, Lord Je - sus, be our guest, and 2 Oh, come, Lord Je - sus, be our guest, and let your gifts to us be blest. Keep us for - ev - er let your gifts to us be blest. Oh, may there be a in your sight, and be our joy, our hearts' de - light. good - ly share on ev - 'ry ta - ble ev - 'ry-where.'

1 Oh, come, Lord Je - sus, be our guest, and
2 Oh, come, Lord Je - sus, be our guest, and
let your gifts to us be blest. Keep us for - ev - er
let your gifts to us be blest. Oh, may there be a
in your sight, and be our joy, our hearts' de - light.
good - ly share on ev - 'ry ta - ble ev - 'ry-where.

**may be sung in canon*

Text: traditional table prayer, adapt. Susan Briehl
Music: TALLIS' CANON, Thomas Tallis

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Loving God,
we offer at your table the gifts of our hearts.
Help us take heart in you and share freely of your love,
so that all creation can taste your abundance.
We ask this in the name of Jesus,
through the Spirit abiding with us now and forever.
Amen.

P: The Lord be with you.

C: And also with you.

P: Lift up your hearts.

C: We lift them to the Lord.

P: Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

C: It is right to give our thanks and praise.

Pastor (sung/spoken): It is indeed right, our duty and our joy, that we should, at all times and in all places, give thanks and praise to you, almighty and merciful God, through our Savior Jesus Christ; who on this day overcame death and the grave, and by his glorious resurrection opened to us the way of everlasting life. And so, with all the choirs of angels, with the church on earth and the hosts of heaven, we praise your name and join their unending hymn:

It is indeed right, our du - ty and our joy,

that we should at all times and in all places give thanks and praise to you,

al - mighty and merciful God, through our Sav - ior Je - sus Christ;

who on this day overcame death and the grave,

and by his glorious resur - rec - tion

opened to us the way of ev - er - last - ing life.

And so, with all the choirs of an - gels,

with the church on earth and the hosts of heav - en,

we praise your name and join their un - end - ing hymn:

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The Congregation SINGS:

**Holy, holy, holy Lord,
God of power and might,
Heaven and earth
are full of your glory.
Hosanna in the highest.**

**Blessed is he who comes
in the name of the Lord.
Hosanna in the highest.
Hosanna in the highest.**

***EUCCHARISTIC PRAYER**

In the night in which he was handed over, our Lord Jesus took bread, and gave thanks; broke it, and gave it to his disciples, saying:

Take and eat; this is my body, given for you. Do this for the remembrance of me.

Again, after supper, he took the cup, gave thanks, and gave it for all to drink, saying:

This cup is the new covenant in my blood, shed for you and for all people for the forgiveness of sin. Do this for the remembrance of me.

***LORD'S PRAYER**

P: Gathered into one by the Holy Spirit, let us pray as Jesus taught us.

**Our Father,
who art in heaven,
hallowed be thy name,
thy kingdom come,
thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day
our daily bread;
and forgive us
our trespasses,**

**as we forgive those
who trespass against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kingdom,
and the power,
and the glory,
forever and ever.
Amen.**

*INVITATION TO COMMUNION

P: From even before you breathed your first breath,
and even after you will breathe your last,
you are God's children and you are welcome at God's Table.
The feast is ready.
Taste and see that the Lord is good.

The Congregation is SEATED

AGNUS DEI (SUNG)

Congregation

Lamb of God, you take away the
sin of the world;
have mercy on us.

Lamb of God, you take away the
sin of the world;
have mercy on us.

Lamb of God, you take away the
sin of the world;
grant us peace.

COMMUNION HYMN: ELW 725

Cuando el pobre

Refrain

We see God, here by our side,
walking our way;
we see God, here by our side,
walking our way.

ENGLISH

1 When the poor ones, who
have nothing, still are giving;
when the thirsty pass the cup,
water to share;
when the wounded offer
others strength and healing:

2 When compassion gives the
suff'ring consolation;
when expecting brings to birth
hope that was lost;
when we choose love, not the
hatred
all around us: Refrain

3 When our spirits, like a
chalice, brim with gladness;
when our voices, full and
clear, sing out the truth;
when our longings, free from
envy, seek the humble: Refrain

4 When the goodness poured
from heaven
fills our dwellings;
when the nations work to
change war into peace;
when the stranger is accepted
as our neighbor: Refrain

SPANISH

1 Cuando el pobre nada tiene
y aún reparte,
cuando alguien pasa sed y
agua nos da,
cuando el débil a su hermano
fortalece:

Estribillo

Va Dios mismo en nuestro
mismo caminar;
va Dios mismo en nuestro
mismo caminar.

2 Cuando alguno sufre y logra
su consuelo,
cuando espera y no se cansa
de esperar,
cuando amamos, aunque el
odio nos rodee: Estribillo

3 Cuando crece la alegría y
nos inunda,
cuando dicen nuestros labios
la verdad,
cuando amamos el sentir de
los sencillos: Estribillo

4 Cuando abunda el bien y
llena los hogares,
cuando alguien donde hay
guerra pone paz,
cuando "hermano" le
llamamos al extraño: Estribillo

Text: José Antonio Olivar, b. 1939; tr. Martin A. Seltz, b. 1951

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****After all have communed, the Congregation STANDS.***

Pastor: The body and blood of our Lord Jesus
strengthen you and keep you in his grace.

Congregation: Amen.

The Congregation SINGS:

Now, Lord, you let your servant go in peace:
your word has been fulfilled.

My own eyes have seen the salvation
which you have prepared in the sight of ev'ry people:
a light to reveal you to the nations
and the glory of your people Israel.
Glory to the Father, and to the Son,
and to the Holy Spirit,
as it was in the beginning, is now,
and will be forever.

Amen.

***PRAYER AFTER COMMUNION**

Communion Assistant

Compassionate God,
through the gifts of bread and wine
our hearts are filled with the abundance of your love.
Strengthen us that we, through this holy meal,
may share your love freely, as you have shared with us.
We ask this in the name of Jesus,
through the Spirit nourishing us now and forever.

Amen.

***BLESSING**

Pastor

Creator, Redeemer, Sustainer,
✠ one God,
bless, heal, and hold you
today and always.

Amen.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

*SENDING HYMN: ELW 858

1 Praise to the Lord, the
Almighty, the King of creation!
O my soul, praise him, for he
is your health and salvation!
Let all who hear now to his
temple draw near,
joining in glad adoration!

2 Praise to the Lord, who o'er
all things is wondrously reigning
and, as on wings of an eagle,
uplifting, sustaining.
Have you not seen all that is
needful has been
sent by his gracious
ordaining?

3 Praise to the Lord, who will
prosper your work and defend
you;
surely his goodness and
mercy shall daily attend you.
Ponder anew what the
Almighty can do
if with his love he befriend
you.

4 Praise to the Lord! Oh, let all
that is in me adore him!
All that has life and breath,
come now with praises before
him!
Let the amen sound from his
people again.
Gladly forever adore him!

Text: Joachim Neander, 1650-1680; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1827-1878, alt.

SENDING

Pastor

Heaven has come near. Go, share the good news!

Thanks be to God.

*POSTLUDE

Savior, Again to Your Dear Name